Suddaby School Council Meeting

November 18, 2024

Present: Katha Broschek, Karin Korth, Lisa Farlow, Sue Campbell, Joel Leslie, Lisa Lynette, Katherine Akins, Chris Greenhough, Kate Leslie, Kristyna Balaban, Virginia Conly, Tony Geer, Jenn Snyder, Katie Elder, Helene Goetz, Madhumita Ghosh, Dayanand Sharma, Ron Syncosa

Regrets: Mel McShane

Land Acknowledgment

Administrators' Report:

- **Progress reports** went out today.

- **EA Hours:** Suddaby has received an additional 30 hours/week of EA time, equalling one F/T position.

- **Playground update:** the WRDSB Facitiltes manager reports that the RFPs for the new kindie playground will go out in December, with spring installation planned.
- The RFP will include all items we had originally requested, and the playground committee will have input
- Although the decision has not been finalized, we are leaning toward using "natural-like" materials (i.e. composite) instead of natural (wood) because it is more durable.

- **Movember**: During the month of November, students can earn ballots for acts of kindness or purchase them for a $1 donation to the Movember (men's health-related research) campaign. At the end of the month there will be a ballot draw to throw a shaving cream pie at a willing staff member.

- **Spirit Days:** the next spirit day will be Shining Star Day, November 29th. Wear your Suddaby Spirit Wear! December 20th will be Wacky Tacky Day, details to follow.

- **Clubs:** The Volleyball, Writing, and Drawing Clubs, and Choirs are up and running, Engineering Club will begin within the next 2 weeks.

- **Construction Update:** The elevator doors will be installed shortly, allowing use of the Lancaster side entrance. The construction end date is planned for September 2025

Discussion Regarding Admin Report:

  - *JL question:* have we asked about moving the basketball nets away from the portable and its utility pole? *Answer:* no request made yet, can look into it.

- *LF question:* Is there sufficient space/equipment for the Cloud and Sensory Rm? *Answer:* Emphasis is on students taking short breaks when needed in the classroom so that they can re-join the class as quickly as possible. All classrooms have sensory equipment available.

Financial Report:

Total across WEFI and Council accounts: **$56,498.90**

- Spent $365 for extra sports pinnies for use by soccer and track teams
- Spent $100.00 for recording of Junior Choir singing anthems for Kitchener Rangers game **vote via email*
- Made $343 from snack sales in at swap meet
- Made $150 from ongoing Mabel's labels fundraiser

Of the total balance:

- $1,184.59 - Remaining "Discretionary Funding" budget
- $4,489.00 - Remaining "Special Projects" budget
- $1,100.00 - Earmarked for lacrosse event and mascot
- $200.00 - Earmarked for sleds for kindie classes
- $40,000.00 - Earmarked for playground
- $5,000.00 - Held in reserve

Fundraising Report:

- One of our Grade 6 teachers has suggested that we increase our popcorn day frequency to twice per month, with her students running them. We would need to have an adult present to help, and are asking for volunteers. If you have time during the school day to come in once per month or even just once, we'd love to hear from you! Please contact us at sud-schoolcouncil@wrdsb.ca or reach out through our Facebook page.
- Spirit wear sales have closed and profited approximately $700; t shirts should be here before the Shining Star Spirit day.

WRAPSC Report:

The possibility of WRAPSC functioning as an advocacy group and writing letters to Trustees was discussed.

Purchase Requests:

1. **Drawing Club** requests up to $200 to buy charcoal and paper.

KA moves to provide up to $200 for art supplies. KB seconds. MOTION PASSED.

2. **Junior/Kodaly Choir** requests $255 to buy sheet music.

LF moves to provide $255 for sheet music. HG seconds. MOTION PASSED.

3. **LaLiLo:** Grade 2 teachers request $700 for site licenses to use La Li Lo literacy support software.

This item is deemed too close to curriculum materials to be an allowable purchase. Request

DENIED.

4. **Gym Equipment:** Teachers request $1000-$1500 to buy upgraded gym equipment.

This item is deemed purchasable through the school budget rather than Council funds.. Request DENIED.

Other Business:

- **ESQ Night:** The University of Waterloo Engineering Dept has offered to come to Suddaby and run an Engineering Science Quest Night for students and their families. Details TBD.
- **Kitchener Ringette:** The Kitchener Ringette Association have generously offered to come to Suddaby for 2 days to demonstrate/teach the sport. We are looking into the feasibility of this; details TBD

● **Strongstart** is an early literacy support program run by volunteers in the school. Volunteers will be paired with children for 10 30-minute (typically weekly) sessions. Training is provided (and mandatory), both online and in person, free of charge.

● Strong Start Link for training:
https://strongstart.ca/programs/letters-sounds-and-words/training/

● The WRDSB now requires all volunteers to complete the volunteer interview form and reference check below, and to provide a Vulnerable Sector Check by the WRPS. There is a fee for the WRPS check of $20 if you indicate that it is required for a volunteer position. If you wish to volunteer and require assistance covering the WRPS fee, please contact Suddaby administration.

● Volunteer Interview Form
https://staff.wrdsb.ca/policyprocedure/files/2020/02/Appendix-A-Volunteer-Application.pdf

● Volunteer Reference Check form
https://staff.wrdsb.ca/policyprocedure/files/2020/02/Appendix-B-Reference-Check.pdf

● WRPS Vulnerable Sector Check:
https://www.wrps.on.ca/en/services-reporting/police-vulnerable-sector-check.aspx

NEXT MEETING: JANUARY 20,2025

HAVE A WONDERFUL HOLIDAY!